

Development & Release Log

Everything built for the Vishvavahini → VishTV relaunch, from inception to the current deployment.

Generated 1 July 2026 · 21 commits · 21 May – 1 July 2026 · 107 files (+26,549 / –4,086) · Project cyxq3hr1

Deployment status

Environment	URL	Branch	At commit	Contains
Production	vishtv.com	main	4923e94 (1 Jul)	v1.0 — LIVE (non-indexed soft launch)
Dev / Staging	dev.vishtv.com	dev	5f11485 (1 Jul)	Everything through v1.0
Legacy (Wix)	vishvavahini.com	—	—	Old site, still live in parallel

v1.0 is LIVE on vishtv.com (PR #1 merged) as a **non-indexed soft launch** (`ALLOW_INDEXING` off → `robots: Disallow / + <meta noindex>`), running parallel to the Wix site. Content verified: 2,481 articles + 991 videos; sitemap 3,498 URLs. **Next:** bake → cutover (indexing on + `vishvavahini.com` DNS repoint → 301s + GSC Change of Address) → decommission Wix (secure the domain first).

Tech stack

- **Next.js 16** (App Router) + **React 19**, TypeScript
- **Sanity 5** headless CMS (embedded Studio at `/studio`), private dataset + server-only read token
- Plain CSS (design tokens + CSS Modules), custom in-house i18n (EN/SI)
- **YouTube Data API v3** (sync, stats, live detection); YouTube iframe playback
- **Vercel** hosting, ISR, cron jobs, Analytics + Speed Insights

v0.1.0 — Foundation 2–3 Jun

The initial build: a working Next.js + Sanity site with the core pages and CMS.

- Project scaffold — Next.js + Sanity + design system (tokens, reset, utilities).
- Core layout & pages — home, watch, browse with Netflix-style rows and tiles.
- Content pages + Sanity Studio at `/studio` with a content-manager desk structure.
- TV / 10-foot mode (`?tv=1`) with D-pad keyboard navigation.
- YouTube auto-sync cron; branded video intro; live-stream support via Site Settings.
- News, events, radio pages; Portable Text article bodies.
- EN/SI i18n toggle; legacy redirects; SEO/OpenGraph metadata.
- Content-manager guide + launch checklist; Vercel deploy config; daily cron (Hobby plan).

Commits: d0bab5c, 528f97b, 6baed71, 6c001af, 451e037, ea29aa4, 59b34b6, 1b2e4b8, cc1d56e

Was the production baseline until v1.0 shipped (1 Jul).

v0.2.0 — Video backfill 7 Jun

- Backfilled ~991 YouTube videos into Sanity (backfill scripts).
- Browse page shows all videos (removed the 60-item cap).
- ISR cache busting after backfill.

Commits: 6a6e22a, bdd2420, 17e6ca8

v1.0.0 — Phase 1 relaunch 30 Jun – 1 Jul

The major relaunch: real Wix content migrated, plus search, SEO, popularity ranking, an autonomous live stream, and the traffic-migration plan. Verified on dev.

Content migration

- **Migrated 2,481 news articles** from the live Wix blog (Wix Blog API → Portable Text), images uploaded to Sanity's CDN, category taxonomy, preserved publish dates.
- Consolidated to a single `production` dataset (2,481 articles + 991 videos + 16 programmes + 10 categories).
- Language retag — 2,478 Sinhala-script articles tagged `si`. Idempotent tooling under `scripts/migrate-wix/`.

CMS & security

- Private dataset + server-only read token — token-free `urlFor` split out so the token never reaches the browser; `write-client` server-only.
- Contact form → Sanity (`contactMessage` schema + Studio "Messages"), with honeypot, validation, same-origin guard.

SEO

- `sitemap.xml` (3,498 URLs) and environment-aware `robots.txt` (dev/staging noindexed).
- 301/308 redirects — every legacy Wix URL → new URL in a single hop.

Features

- Search across articles/videos/programmes (EN + Sinhala); news category filter; related articles.
- Privacy policy page (rebuilt from the live Wix policy).
- Home popularity rows with framed images: Trending this week (momentum), Most watched (all-time), From the newsroom, Most read.
- View-tracking + popularity system: article view counter, daily `refresh-stats` cron computing weekly deltas + `trendingScore`.
- Autonomous live stream — `/watch` detects the current live broadcast via the YouTube API (cached), with a graceful off-air state.

Fixes & hardening

- Fixed Sinhala article pages (route params not auto-decoded → added `decodeSlug`).
- 16:9 trending tiles; pre-merge review hardening (API live detection, view-track abuse guard, authenticated CDN reads).

Documentation

- Migration & cutover plan (`docs/MIGRATION-CUTOVER.md` + PDF): DNS strategy, launch-first sequencing, SEO handoff, Wix-takedown risk checklist.

Commits: `bae2459`, `04be84e`, `cf71b3f`, `7295964`, `5229fb3`, `a046b4e`, `231fff4`, `7d06624`, `97d2475`

Feature inventory (current, on dev)

Content & CMS: 2,481 articles · 991 videos · 16 programmes · 10 categories · embedded Sanity Studio · contact-message inbox · Site Settings · daily YouTube sync.

Discovery: search · news category filter · related articles · trending / most-watched / most-read rows · browse by programme.

Playback: YouTube embeds · branded intro · autonomous live stream · radio.

Popularity: article view tracking · weekly + all-time rankings · daily stats cron.

Platform: private dataset + server-only tokens · ISR · env-aware SEO · single-hop legacy redirects · EN/SI i18n · TV 10-foot mode · Vercel Analytics + Speed Insights.

Known follow-ups (not yet built)

- Browse page renders up to 2,000 image tiles — add pagination / "load more".
- Contact form rate-limiting (currently Next server-action CSRF + honeypot).
- Optional: named author profiles; Movies/Teledrama reclassified as `video + programme` .
- Weekly-trending data becomes accurate ~7 days after the stats cron begins running in production.